

A1 Video Essay

GBDA 302

Group 6A

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Script

Catherine Patterson: Introduction & Game Structure

Luigi's Mansion 3 is an action/adventure that came up in 2019 [15]. Following the first and second Luigi's Mansion game in which Luigi partners up with Professor E. Gadd to defeat King Boo and save the Evershade Valley, in Luigi's Mansion 3 King Boo returns and captures Luigi's friends from their hotel, trapping them in frames. The problem: Luigi alone can save them [17].

In this video I will talk about Tutorial goal and Game Structure, Joy will cover gameplay elements, Megan: affordances, Lulu: gameflow, Amy: player experience, and Zahra will conclude with an evidence synthesis.

The goal of the game is simple: Luigi has to save his friends from being trapped in King Boo's art collection by making his way to the top floor of the hotel [17].

In the tutorial level, Luigi explores the first floor and the basement. With the help of his companion, Polterpup, the player learns the core vacuum mechanics, how to defeat ghosts, what might cause damage (like the rats and ghosts), what kind of objects the player might interact with and frees Professor E Gadd sets up his temporary lab who then hand him the Virtual Boo to communicate with him [13]. During the tutorial, Luigi also finds a new flashlight bulb, the Dark-Light Device, which releases treasures and characters from their frames [13]. This makes for a guided experience while leaving the player with enough freedom to discover features themselves.

The player wins if they reach the final top floor of the hotel and defeat King Boo, releasing all of Luigi's friends and lose if Luigi loses 99 health points [15].

As for player controls, Luigi can move front, back and to the sides using the left joystick, click X to interact with objects (like doors, looking into windows, open chests) and hold B while walking to run [13]. A lot of controls are the same from Luigi's Mansion 2 but as a refresher (and for new players), Polterpup shows Luigi how to hold A to charge and release to flash the Strobulp, holding ZR to vacuum suck, ZL to vacuum blow, and clicking ZR and ZL to create a powerful blast [13].

Game mechanics are gradually introduced naturally as the story progresses. Some shown in the tutorial include: the ghost fighting combat which interestingly is not explicitly taught but was present in Luigi's Mansion 2 [24], opening locked doors that have a dark circle with a yellow outline with a Strobulp flash (which also is not explicit taught), as well as finding hidden golden keys to unlock the new hotel rooms to explore [13].

The game loop in this game is simple: select a floor in the elevator, explore it to complete the mission (which often includes solving puzzles and defeating ghosts), get more elevator buttons, and explore the next floor [13].

With that, let's move on to gameplay elements.

Joy Zhang: Gameplay Elements

In Luigi's Mansion, the tutorial does not rely too much on direct instructions. Instead, it guides the player through the environment, Luigi's reactions, and small controlled interactions.

The game world is introduced when Luigi arrives at the mansion and explores dim, mostly empty rooms [21]. Since there is no immediate threat, the player has time to look around, notice doors and objects, and understand how the rooms connect. This shows that moving forward depends on exploring each area and interacting with the environment [7]. Then, when Luigi is brought to Professor E. Gadd's lab, the structure changes [21].

The mansion feels uncertain, while the lab feels like a safer place to learn. This contrast helps the player understand that the lab is where mechanics are introduced, and the mansion is where those mechanics are applied.

Luigi's character further shapes how players approach the game. His nervous reactions, from trembling when standing still to flinching at ghosts, show that he isn't a character built for direct combat. As a result, the player learns to approach encounters carefully and rely on tools instead of attacking right away [21]. Luigi's nervous animations also make the player slow down and think before acting. This cautious approach is reinforced by the game's rules and constraints.

Early in the game, locked doors show that the player cannot move forward freely. To progress, the player needs to find keys and return to certain spaces [7]. Ghost encounters also teach a clear sequence of actions.

Ghosts cannot be captured right away. The player first has to stun the ghost, reveal its heart, and then use the Poltergust [13, 17]. This helps the player learn the correct process instead of just pressing buttons randomly. By limiting what the player can do at each step, the game makes the main mechanic easier to understand before moving on.

The interface also supports learning without showing too much information at once. The health meter shows the result of taking damage, so the player can clearly see when they made a mistake [18]. Other information, such as ghost health, only appears during ghost encounters. This keeps the screen simple while still giving useful feedback when the player needs it. Since the information appears during the action, the player learns by playing instead of just reading instructions.

Audio and visual feedback reinforce this process. Changes in lighting and sound often occur before a ghost is fully visible, signalling that something is about to happen [21]. Over time, players begin to associate these cues with danger or opportunity, allowing them to anticipate events rather than react to them. This builds a more intuitive understanding of the game's systems.

Finally, the core mechanics are introduced in a controlled training sequence with Professor E. Gadd [11]. Here, players practice capturing ghosts in an environment with no real risk. The process is introduced step by step, with players first learning positioning, then using the flashlight to stun ghosts, and finally using the Poltergust to capture them [13, 17].

Because the player can repeat this sequence safely, the mechanics become familiar before being applied in the mansion itself.

By combining environmental design, character cues, and structured interaction, the tutorial gradually builds the player's confidence by introducing mechanics in a controlled environment before applying them in the mansion.

Megan Pilkey: Affordances

Real Affordances

Affordances describe the interactions between players and the game world that encourage engagement. They help maintain fairness, challenge, and skill development by shaping how players understand what actions are possible. Bystad et al. (2016) describes affordances as the *action possibilities* that emerge when a user interacts with a system toward "immediate tangible outcomes." [9].

In *Luigi's Mansion 3*, we see several clear examples: Luigi opens doors and drawers with handles. This teaches players that handles signal interaction. If it has a handle, Luigi can open it. This is a consistent, reliable mechanic. Luigi can also vacuum objects to reveal hidden coins. Players quickly learn that suction isn't just decorative, it's a tool for uncovering rewards. This encourages exploration and reinforces the idea that interacting with the environment leads to tangible outcomes. Luigi uses the Poltergust to vacuum and fight

ghosts. This is a core mechanic that defines combat. The player learns that vacuuming weakens ghosts, and slamming them finishes the fight. Real affordances matter because they give players confidence. When actions consistently work, players feel like their choices matter and that they're progressing through skill, not guesswork [23].

Perceived Affordances

Next, we have perceived affordances, what players *believe* they can do based on visual cues, sound cues, cultural expectations, and past experience. This idea connects to Don Norman's *The Design of Everyday Things*, which explains how people interpret the function of objects based on how they look [8]. In Luigi's Mansion 3, perceived affordances shape how players interpret the environment: Curtains, tablecloths, loose objects, and decorations often shine, move slightly, or look loose. These cues suggest that Luigi should vacuum them. Players expect interaction because the game visually draws their attention to these objects. At 13:43 to 13:50, there's a trolley that *looks* like it should move. It has wheels, it's positioned at the side of the room, and it resembles a real life movable object. But when Luigi tries to push it, nothing happens. This is a misaligned affordance, the object suggests movement, but the game doesn't allow it. Another example appears at 32:20 to 32:40, where players vacuum objects expecting hidden advantages like coins, gems, switches, or buttons [23]. This belief is shaped by repeated reinforcement earlier in the game. Perceived affordances influence how players approach challenges. They guide attention, shape expectations, and help players form mental models of how the game world works [4].

Feedback

The third key concept is feedback, the immediate response the game gives to validate the player's actions. Feedback is often called "*the silent teacher of games*" because it reinforces learning without needing explicit instructions [10]. Feedback is essential because it: confirms whether an action worked, makes the game feel responsive, motivates players to continue, helps players adjust their strategy and signals progress or danger [4]. For example, at 38:18 to 38:27, when Luigi vacuums a gem, it instantly appears in his gem count [23]. This quick response tells the player they succeeded and encourages them to keep exploring.

How These Elements Support or Hinder Player Learning

Together, real affordances, perceived affordances, and feedback create a learning loop. Real affordances support learning by giving players reliable mechanics [3]. When Luigi opens a door and enters a new area, players feel their actions matter. Perceived affordances help players interpret the environment. They learn which objects are worth interacting with and which aren't. For example, after discovering the trolley doesn't move, players won't waste time trying again [23]. However, misaligned affordances can hinder learning. If players can't trust their instincts, they may hesitate or second-guess future interactions. Finally, feedback strongly supports learning by confirming whether actions were successful [4]. It helps players adapt quickly and stay motivated.

Conclusion

In summary, real affordances, perceived affordances, and feedback work together to shape

how players understand and navigate a game. When aligned, they create a smooth, intuitive, and engaging experience. When misaligned, they can cause confusion, but even that becomes part of the learning process.

Louloua Dabyan: Gameflow

Today, I'm going to look at how Luigi's Mansion 3's tutorial follows three principles from GameFlow, a framework created by Sweetser and Wyeth in 2005 that helps explain what makes games enjoyable [4]. The three principles I'll focus on are Concentration, Feedback, and Challenge.

Principle 1: Concentration

According to GameFlow, players should always have clear and manageable goals so they know what to do next [4]. When goals are clear, players can stay focused instead of feeling confused or overwhelmed.

In the Last Resort Hotel tutorial, the game does this well most of the time. Professor E. Gadd communicates with Luigi through a video call system, giving the player clear direction on where to go and what to do. The objectives are introduced one at a time, first find your friends, then get the elevator button [26].

However, there are moments where this breaks down. When Luigi first enters certain rooms, the game expects him to figure out interactions independently with very little guidance. For a first-time player, standing in a room full of interactive objects with no clear instruction on what matters can feel overwhelming. The goal is technically present but not always communicated clearly, which works against this GameFlow principle [5].

Principle 2: Feedback

GameFlow also says players need clear and immediate feedback so they know whether their actions were successful [4]. Good feedback helps players learn and keeps the game moving forward [11].

The tutorial does a strong job of this in most situations. When Luigi takes damage, he flashes red and his health bar visibly drops, clearly communicating that something hurt him and should be avoided [26]. These feedback responses are consistent and easy to read.

Where feedback falls short is in moments of failed interaction. At 13:43 to 13:50, Luigi approaches a trolley that looks like it should move but nothing happens, no sound, no visual reaction, no explanation [26]. For a tutorial specifically designed to teach the player how the game world works, silent failures are a missed opportunity. The contrast between the gem pickup feedback and the trolley non-response shows how inconsistent the feedback can be in this section.

Principle 3: Challenge and Skill

The final principle is Challenge and Skill. GameFlow argues that games should match the difficulty of challenges to the player's current skill level [4]. Challenges should be interesting enough to engage but not so hard they cause frustration.

Overall, Luigi's Mansion 3 handles this well in the tutorial. At 46:22 to 46:32, the first ghost encounters involve just one or two ghosts in a controlled environment, giving players time to learn the flash-then-vacuum mechanic without too much pressure [26].

That said, the very first ghost combat sequence asks players to combine several actions at once — aim, hold ZR to sustain suction, watch the ghost's eyes, time the A button flash to stun, then continue vacuuming. For players already comfortable with dual-stick controls this feels natural. For someone new to the Nintendo Switch. The tutorial should be at its most accessible [26]. The skill curve briefly spikes when it should be at its flattest.

Conclusion

Overall, the Last Resort Hotel tutorial shows a solid understanding of GameFlow principles. It provides mostly clear goals, strong feedback in key moments, and a gradual difficulty curve [4, 5]. However, the moments where goals become unclear, feedback disappears, or the challenge spikes unexpectedly are precisely where players are most likely to disengage. In a tutorial, those gaps matter most because the entire purpose is to build player confidence and understanding before the rest of the game begins.

Amy Liu: Assumptions and Player Experience

Moving into the player assumptions and experience analysis. The game seems to assume that players are already comfortable with dual-stick controls on the Nintendo Switch. There are quite a few buttons to keep track of, for example, Y is used for the suction shot and A is used for the Strobuls [5]. For first-time players, this can feel a bit overwhelming and hard to memorize. An example that tests this assumption is the very first ghost encounter in the first floor Grand Lobby. The player is asked to move with one stick, aim with the other, hold ZR to use the Poltergust, and time the Strobuls flash with A [20]. Since ZR is a shoulder button, new players might not immediately know where it is or how to use it comfortably [5].

The game also assumes that players are familiar with action-adventure game conventions. Elements like maps, collectibles such as gems, health hearts, currency, and tool-gated progression are never explained in detail [6]. Instead, players are expected to understand what these systems represent, for example, losing health can clearly signal an incorrect action [22].

There are also smaller mechanics that aren't really taught, such as peeking through holes in walls, which the game just expects players to recognise as something they can interact with [22].

Later, on Floor 5 in the RIP Suites, this pattern continues with the Dark-Light Device. The game does not heavily explain its use for revealing hidden interactions, such as uncovering

concealed objects or ghosts [22]. Instead, players are expected to experiment and recognise when the device should be used.

These assumptions definitely support experienced switch players, people who already know how camera control works in 3D space or how to read subtle visual hints [22]. But at the same time they can exclude players who are new to Nintendo Switch, players who mostly use touchscreens, or anyone who struggles with multi-button coordination. Even players with reading difficulties because they might miss the quick text prompts [22].

Reflecting on it, I realized my analysis is filtered through the tutorials videos that I watched and my own familiarity with the game [20, 21, 22]. Watching someone with no prior experience play through the tutorial would probably reveal a very different set of challenges and assumptions.

Zahra Omar: Evidence Synthesis

The tutorial in Luigi's Mansion 3 works as a guided learning experience built on structure, interaction, feedback, and gradual discovery.

Catherine shows that the tutorial starts with the fundamentals: Luigi's main objective, rescuing his friends and collecting elevator buttons, is introduced immediately, along with the core gameplay loop of exploring floors, solving puzzles, fighting ghosts, and progressing upward. This gives players a clear foundation before complexity increases.

Joy highlights that the game teaches primarily through environmental cues rather than text. Luigi's animations, the eerie hotel setting, blocked paths, ghost encounters, and a simple HUD all signal risk, goals, and interactivity. Players learn by experimenting, observing, and responding to audiovisual feedback.

Megan's affordance analysis shows how the tutorial communicates what can be interacted with. Doors, drawers, gems, and ghosts provide clear affordances, while misleading objects like the trolley create confusion. Effective affordances speed up learning; unclear ones slow it down.

Lulu's GameFlow perspective reinforces this. The tutorial sets clear goals, provides instant feedback, and offers manageable challenges. Hints from Polterpup and Professor E. Gadd keep players oriented, while sound effects and enemy reactions confirm successful actions. However, moments of weak guidance or multi-input combat can overwhelm beginners.

Amy's player-experience section adds that the tutorial assumes some prior gaming familiarity. Experienced players adapt quickly, but newcomers may struggle with aiming, timing, and multi-button actions, especially during ghost battles requiring simultaneous inputs.

Overall, the tutorial succeeds because its goals, feedback, and controls align, allowing players to learn naturally through play. Clear cues, responsive feedback, and repeated practice build confidence. Still, occasional unclear affordances and assumed prior knowledge can hinder true beginners. Even so, Luigi's Mansion 3 demonstrates how strong tutorial design can effectively support player learning.

Process Document

Project Decisions (Group-Level)

1. Assigning Roles

- To manage the workload more efficiently, our team first held an initial meeting to review and discuss the project requirements together.
- Following this, tasks were assigned and distributed based on individual strengths, with each member taking on both a primary and a supporting (shadow) responsibility. The purpose of this approach was to ensure a more balanced workload while allowing each team member to contribute in areas where they felt most confident.
- In addition, the team used a scheduling tool (LettuceMeet) to collect everyone's availability and coordinate meeting times.
- Based on this input, it was agreed that the team would meet twice a week to maintain alignment, track progress, and ensure that all members were clear on their responsibilities throughout the project.
- What we decided to change was to move the second meeting to an in-person meeting after class, as this time works for almost everyone. This also allows us to communicate more effectively and identify what still needs to be completed in order to finish the assignment as a group.

2. Giving Ourselves Deadlines

- To ensure we would have enough time to review the assignment as a team before submission, we agreed to have all our narration finished by Wednesday June 3rd.
- Having a structured approach made each group member accountable to finish their work on time and gave the editing team at least 48 hours to edit (though most finished the narration early). This also meant Megan, in charge of citations, would have access to all the sources we used 48 hours in advance to have plenty of time to do a proper references list.
- With the editing team having the final edit done by Friday afternoon, each group member was able to view the final video and give feedback before the submission deadline.

3. Script Distribution

- Initially, our group planned to have one member handle the narration for the entire video while the remaining members focused on the research and

analysis. However, during our group meeting, we revisited this approach and decided that each member would narrate the section they were responsible for analyzing.

- We reached this decision through a group discussion about how to distribute the workload fairly and ensure that everyone could contribute meaningfully to the project. If one person were responsible for all of the narration, they would have less involvement in the analytical portion of the assignment, creating an imbalance in the workload.
- By having each member analyze a specific game machine and narrate their own findings, everyone was able to gain a deeper understanding of the machine they studied and take ownership of their contribution. This approach also helped ensure that all group members were actively involved throughout the research, analysis, and production stages of the project.
- As a result, the final workflow was collaborative, with every member participating in both the analysis and narration. This allowed us to distribute responsibilities more evenly while ensuring that each person developed a thorough understanding of their assigned topic.

4. Video Style

- At the beginning of the project, we decided to have one main editor and one supporting editor. We also agreed that we wanted the video to be mostly visual, using gameplay footage and examples rather than a lot of on-screen text.
- As we started editing, we quickly realized that the workload for the main editor was much heavier than we originally expected. They not only had to put the video together, but also spent a lot of time going through footage, finding specific timestamps, and matching clips to each person's narration. This became very time-consuming and slowed down the editing process.
- To make the workflow more manageable, we discussed it as a group and decided to redistribute some of the editing responsibilities. Members who had finished their research and analysis earlier stepped in to help with editing. So some of us ended up editing our own sections instead of sending everything to the main editor.
- This worked well because we already understood the content we had researched and narrated. We knew which clips were most relevant, what examples we wanted to show, and how the visuals could better support our points. Editing our own sections also reduced the amount of back-and-forth communication needed and made the overall process more efficient.
- By making this adjustment, we were able to balance the workload more fairly, speed up the editing process, and create a stronger connection between the narration and the visuals in each section.
- Also, to maintain a consistent style throughout the video, we also had our main editor review everyone's sections before combining them into the final version. Since we wanted the video to have a cohesive visual style and overall

feel, this review process helped ensure that all parts aligned with our original vision.

- During this review, Zahra, our main editor, noticed a few inconsistencies across different sections. For example, some team members had used footage from different versions of *Luigi's Mansion*, such as *Luigi's Mansion 2*, while others were using footage from the version we had agreed to focus on. To keep the content consistent and avoid confusion, we went back and replaced the clips that did not match our chosen game version.
- By having a final review stage, we were able to identify and fix these inconsistencies before assembling the complete video, resulting in a more polished and cohesive final product.

Role-Based Process Evidence (Individual Entries)

Name: Amy Liu

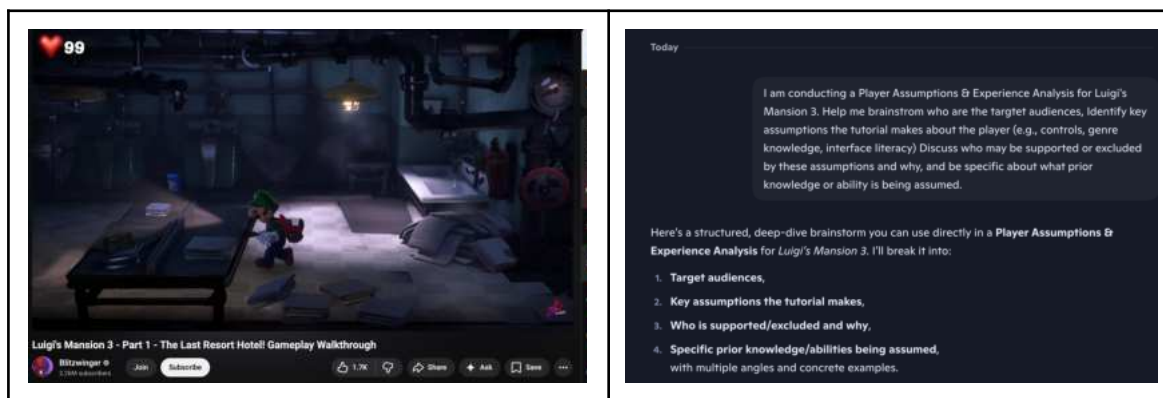
Role(s): Game researcher focusing on player assumptions

Primary responsibility: Player Assumptions & Experience Analyst

Goal of Work Session: The goal of this work session was to identify player assumptions and analyze the user experience in *Luigi's Mansion 3*. My primary responsibility was to understand and interpret the game's target audience, as well as evaluate which groups of players are supported by the game's design and which groups may be unintentionally excluded. This involved examining gameplay mechanics, accessibility, difficulty, and overall player expectations to better understand how the game caters to different users.

Tools / Resources Used:

- YouTube tutorials (Used to better understand the gameplay)
- Copilot (Used as a brainstorming and research support tool to help organize initial ideas)



Summary of Process:

To begin my analysis, I first watched several YouTube tutorials to gain a better understanding of *Luigi's Mansion 3*, including its gameplay mechanics, progression system, and overall player experience. Since I had not played the game before, these tutorials helped me observe how players interact with the game and identify key design elements that could influence different audiences.

After developing a basic understanding of the game, I used Copilot as a brainstorming tool to help generate initial analytical angles and questions related to player assumptions, inclusivity, and user experience. Rather than using its suggestions directly, I used them as a starting point to organize my thoughts and explore areas that I may not have considered on my own.

Lastly, I refined my analysis by combining the ideas generated during brainstorming with my own observations and understanding of the game gathered from the tutorials. This process allowed me to think more critically about the game's design decisions and develop conclusions that were supported by both research and my own interpretation.

Decision Points:

- One decision I made was to remove a point suggested by Copilot, which stated that the game's visuals, pacing, and slapstick humor primarily appeal to children. After reviewing some gameplay tutorials, I found that most of the players featured were adults or teenagers rather than young children. Also, based on my own observations, the people around me who own and regularly play on a Nintendo Switch tend to be in my age group rather than younger kids. So I felt there was insufficient evidence to support the claim that children are the primary target audience, so I chose not to include this point in my final analysis.

• Younger children

The game's visuals, pacing, and slapstick humor appeal strongly to kids. The tutorial is designed to be friendly and non-punitive.

- Another decision I made was to group this point under the broader assumption that players are already familiar with console controllers and Nintendo Switch controls. Since I feel like this point was not strong enough to stand as a separate assumption. However, when placed within the context of prior Nintendo gameplay experience, it becomes more coherent, as players familiar with Nintendo systems are more likely to already understand common input patterns, such as holding triggers or combining multiple button actions.

3. Pressure-sensitive triggers

The Poltergust uses analog triggers for suction/blow strength.

Assumed prior knowledge:

Understanding that triggers can be held, not just tapped.

Verification:

- Copilot
- Group discussion

Limitations / Challenges:

One limitation of this analysis is that it was primarily based on watching YouTube gameplay tutorials rather than playing the game directly. While these videos were helpful for understanding mechanics and progression, they often show more experienced or efficient playthroughs, which can hide moments of confusion or learning difficulty that a new player might experience. As a result, some of my conclusions about player assumptions are inferred rather than directly observed.

Name: Megan Pilkey

Role(s): Affordances Analyst & Referencing Formatting

Primary responsibility: Affordances Analyst

Goal of Work Session:

Throughout this session I was trying to accomplish defining affordances and game feedback in my own words, using examples from *Luigi's Mansion 3*. I analyzed Youtube videos of the game play to further understand affordances in general, but also understand how the relationship between affordances and feedback affect players' learning throughout game play.

Tools / Resources Used: (e.g., lecture notes, teammates, editing software, references, GenAI if used)

I used week 2 and 3 lecture notes, Youtube tutorials of the game, a peer-reviewed article, research articles, MyBib citation generator and Microsoft Co-Pilot.

Summary of Process:

I watched a Youtube walkthrough of someone playing *Luigi's Mansion 3* for the first time to get a better understanding of how the game works and relate to someone who has never played the game before. I read through the lecture slides to get a baseline understanding of what affordances and feedback are so that I had some background knowledge before watching the walkthrough videos. I then watched the walkthrough video again and picked out certain scenes that were examples of the real, perceived, misaligned affordances and game play feedback. I took notes along the way defining what each part meant and finding an example with a video time stamp. I then took all my original notes and asked Co-Pilot to help me create a 4-5 minute script based on my findings.

Decision Points:

I decided to use the University of Waterloo Library to locate my peer-reviewed citation beyond course materials to ensure the citation was credible. I also decided to select various

time stamps from the walkthrough Youtube video to showcase different areas and scenes in *Luigi's Mansion 3* rather than all of the examples coming from a similar area.

Verification:

I double checked how I defined affordances and feedback in my own words against the lecture slides posted and against the articles I used for my research. I also ensured that the examples from the walkthrough video I choose clearly aligned with my work and the clearly defined examples in the lecture slides. I also took a look at my other group members' work to gain a stronger understanding around other aspects of the game for example, player assumptions and gameplay elements.

Limitations / Challenges:

When I was locating a peer-reviewed citation in the University of Waterloo Library I had to search through many articles to find one that talked about game affordances in the way I needed. For example, the article I chose explored affordances in digital games which aligned perfectly with this assignment.

Name: Joy Zhang

Role(s): Gameplay Elements Analyst

Primary responsibility:

Analyze the gameplay elements introduced during the tutorial and explain how they help players learn the game's mechanics.

Goal of Work Session:

To identify and analyze the gameplay elements taught in the tutorial section of Luigi's Mansion.

Tools / Resources Used:

Summary of Process: What you did, focus on actions, not final results.

I watched YouTube tutorials of the game to gain a good understanding of the game and took notes on the game world, player character, rules and constraints, interface elements, audio and visual feedback, and core mechanics. I also organized the information into categories, identified gameplay examples for each section, found relevant video footage and timestamps, and drafted explanations connecting the examples to player learning.

Decision Points:

1. I chose to organize my analysis by gameplay element categories to make the tutorial structure easier to explain.
2. I selected footage that clearly demonstrated each gameplay element so the evidence would match the analysis.

Verification:

I compared my observations to course concepts about tutorials and gameplay design and discussed section responsibilities with group members to reduce overlap.

Limitations / Challenges:

Some gameplay footage was lengthy, so it took time to find appropriate examples and timestamps. There was also some overlap between group sections that required clarification.

Name: Lulu Dabyan

Role(s): GameFlow Analyst / Script Integration Support

Primary Responsibility: Analyze the Gloomy Manor tutorial using three GameFlow principles and write the GameFlow section of the video essay script.

Goal of Work Session: Identify three GameFlow principles clearly demonstrated in the Luigi's Mansion 3 HD tutorial and write a 4–5 minute script section with specific gameplay examples and peer-reviewed support.

Tools / Resources Used: Sweetser & Wyeth (2005) GameFlow paper, GBDA 302 Week 2 & 3 lecture slides, Luigi's Mansion 3 HD tutorial walkthrough (YouTube), shared group Google Doc, Microsoft Copilot (UW account).

Summary of Process: Watched the Gloomy Manor tutorial walkthrough to identify gameplay moments relevant to GameFlow. Used Copilot to clarify the eight GameFlow principles and narrow down which three were most supported by tutorial evidence. Selected Concentration, Feedback, and Challenge based on available gameplay examples. Drafted script analysis for each principle covering both effective and less effective implementation. Reviewed other group members' sections to identify transition points and ensure consistent tone across the essay.

Decision Points:

- Chose Concentration over Immersion because Professor Gadd's DS communication provided clearer, more specific examples to analyze from the tutorial footage
- Decided to connect the Challenge section to Amy's player assumptions analysis to avoid repetition and create cohesion across the two sections

Verification: Cross-referenced principle definitions against the Sweetser & Wyeth (2005) paper. Compared examples to course concepts from lecture slides. Reviewed the full group script to check flow between sections.

Limitations / Challenges: Gameplay analysis was based on a YouTube walkthrough rather than direct play, which meant some non-linear player interactions may have been missed.

Name: Zahra Omar

Role(s): Evidence Synthesis & Presentation Analyst, Final editing / documentation support

Primary responsibility: Evidence Synthesis

Goal of Work Session: The goal of this work session was to review all group members' analyses and identify the key findings that connected across different sections. My responsibility was to make sure that each claim made in the video essay was supported by tutorial evidence and that the final presentation flowed logically from one topic to the next. I was to also combine all video recordings including my own to put it into one video essay while making sure to add any game clips that are put with the script recordings.

Tools / Resources Used:

- Google docs
- Group meeting discussions
- iMovie

Summary of Process:

I went through every team member's notes and video to spot themes about player learning, tutorial design, feedback and progression. Comparing gameplay examples, I put together a conclusion linking the group's main insights. Also, I made sure the videos and clips we put smoothly by checking between sections and keeping the referencing consistent throughout the video essay.

Decision Points:

- Chose to emphasize how multiple design elements work together to teach players throughout the game.

Verification:

I looked over my work and my peers work a bunch of times. I tried to let my group members know if there was anything that needed to be fixed or changed in our group chat. I also looked over the assignment requirements a bunch of times.

Limitations / Challenges:

Making sure the analysis didn't overlap or repeat itself. Also making sure my teammates are not getting confused in what they are researching, for example looking at another version of Luigi's Mansion.

Name: Catherine Patterson

Role(s): Introduction, Tutorial Goal and Core Elements, Video Editing Support

Primary responsibility: Introduce the game's storyline to viewers, explain the video essay structure, state the game goal, identify the win/lose condition, discuss player controls, show game mechanics introduced in the tutorial level and the game loop.

Goal of Work Session: The goal of this work session was to find a way to concisely provide the viewer with enough information about the game's story to peak interest and give an overview of what the player is taught in the tutorial level of Luigi's Mansion 3.

Tools / Resources Used:

- Luigi's Mansion 1, 2 and 3 game wiki to catch viewers up to speed with the game lore
- Luigi's Mansion 1, 2, and 3 game walkthroughs to make meaningful game mechanics and player control links between the games and understand player starting knowledge
- Premiere Pro to edit video clips and narration

Summary of Process: I started by first watching 2 Youtube video walkthroughs of Luigi's Mansion 3, the first a speedrun version to get a sense of the game, the second a first-time player perspective to watch what errors players might make (like taking damage from a rat in the basement). Next I went to the Luigi's Mansion wiki, taking notes about Luigi's Mansion 1, 2 and 3 to find where the 3rd video game picks up in the storyline, answering questions like: What characters is the player familiar with? How did Luigi get acquainted with Polterpup? Why is King Boo the villain and exacting revenge on Luigi and his friends? From there I started writing my script which meant going back to the walkthroughs often to look at how player controls are introduced and game mechanics present in the tutorial. I realized in none of the walkthroughs does the Luigi lose 99 lives in the tutorial so I watched another video to see what the lose condition looks like to players. Additionally, to find the win condition I watched another video of a player reaching the top floor of the hotel and defeating King Boo. Once the script was finished, I recorded it and gathered the video clips I needed. Last, I edited my section in Premiere Pro and uploaded it to the team Drive for feedback.

Decision Points: I decided to do additional research into Luigi's Mansion 1 and 2 and include video clips from the latter to give a more comprehensive overview of the game storyline and peak viewer interest instead of simply starting from the story in Luigi's Mansion 3. This explains to viewers who the characters are and their motivations. Another decision I made was cross referencing game mechanics from Luigi's Mansion 2 and 3 to justify why certain mechanics were not explicitly taught in the tutorial level. Viewers understand that the games are connected and build off one another, highlighting an interesting game design decision.

Verification: Talked with team members to ensure there was no significant overlap between parts, discussed the time limit for my section to make sure the video does not run overtime, double checked with the editing team that the video runs smoothly once uploaded to the Drive.

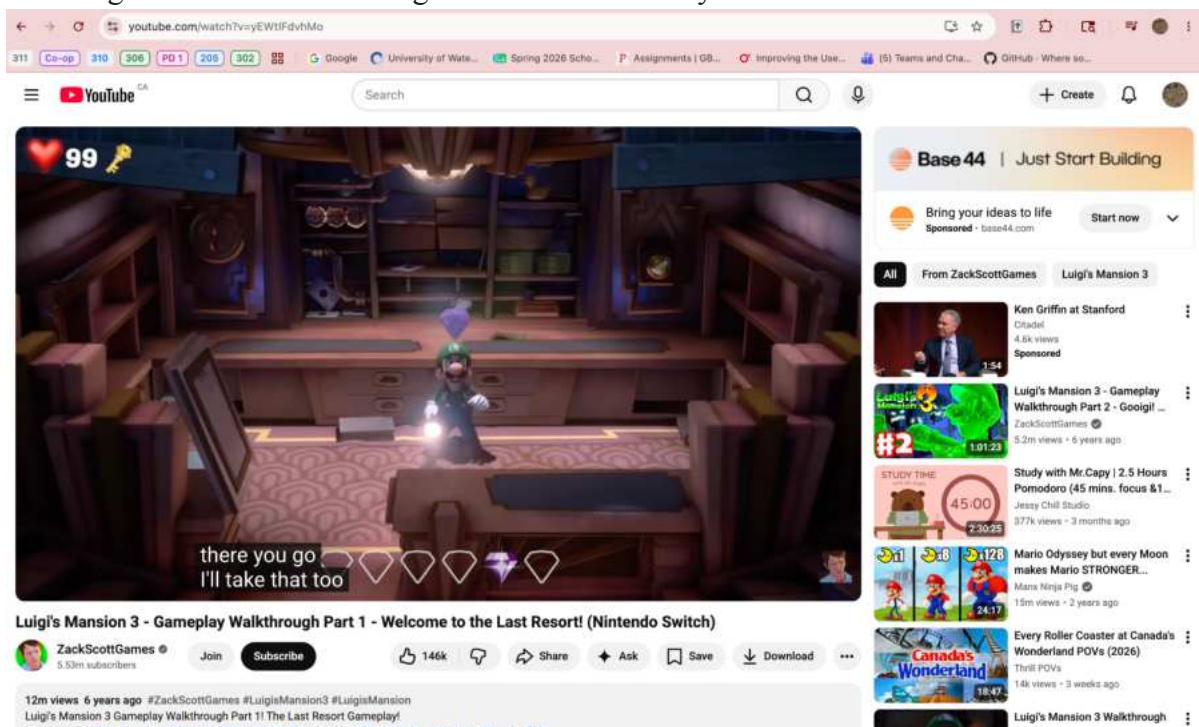
Limitations / Challenges:

Embarrassingly, I was under the assumption for a full week that the assigned game for the team was Luigi's Mansion 2 not 3. I did all my research, script and final video editing for the wrong game. Luckily teammates pointed it out and I was able to go back and do the assignment correctly but this was a huge setback. In the end, the research I did on Luigi's Mansion 2 proved useful as I could use this knowledge to draw in-depth parallels between the two games.

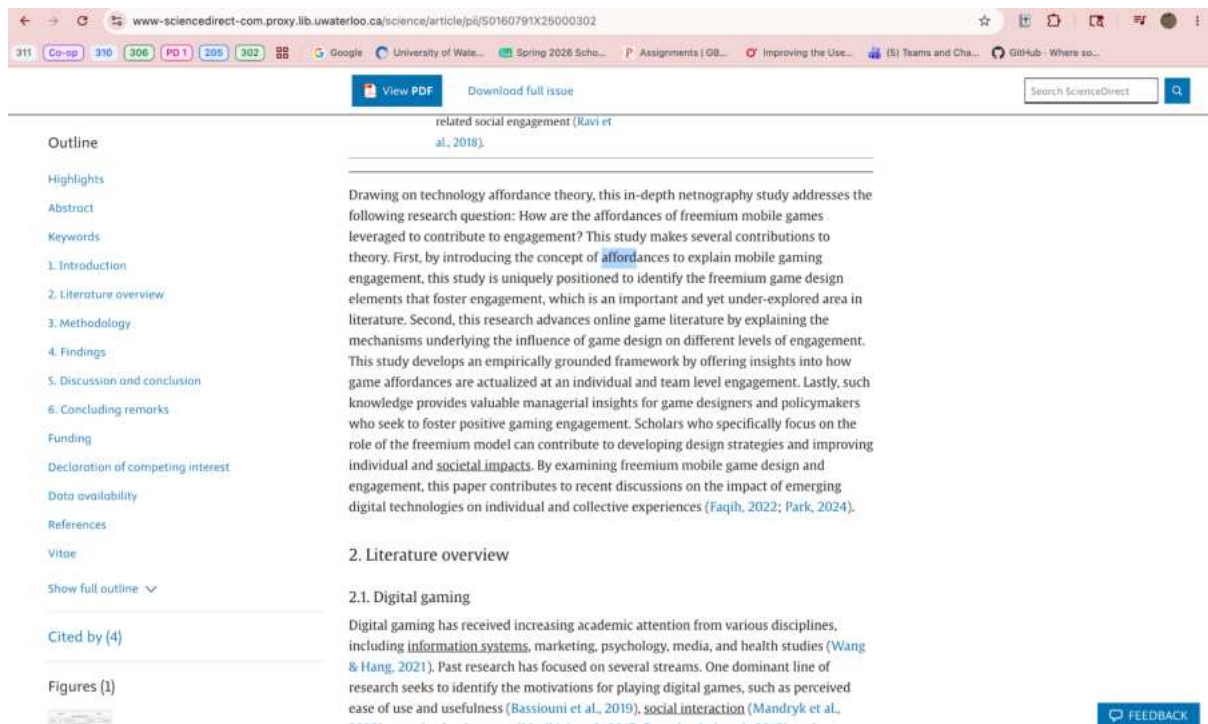
Required Process Evidence

Megan Pilkey

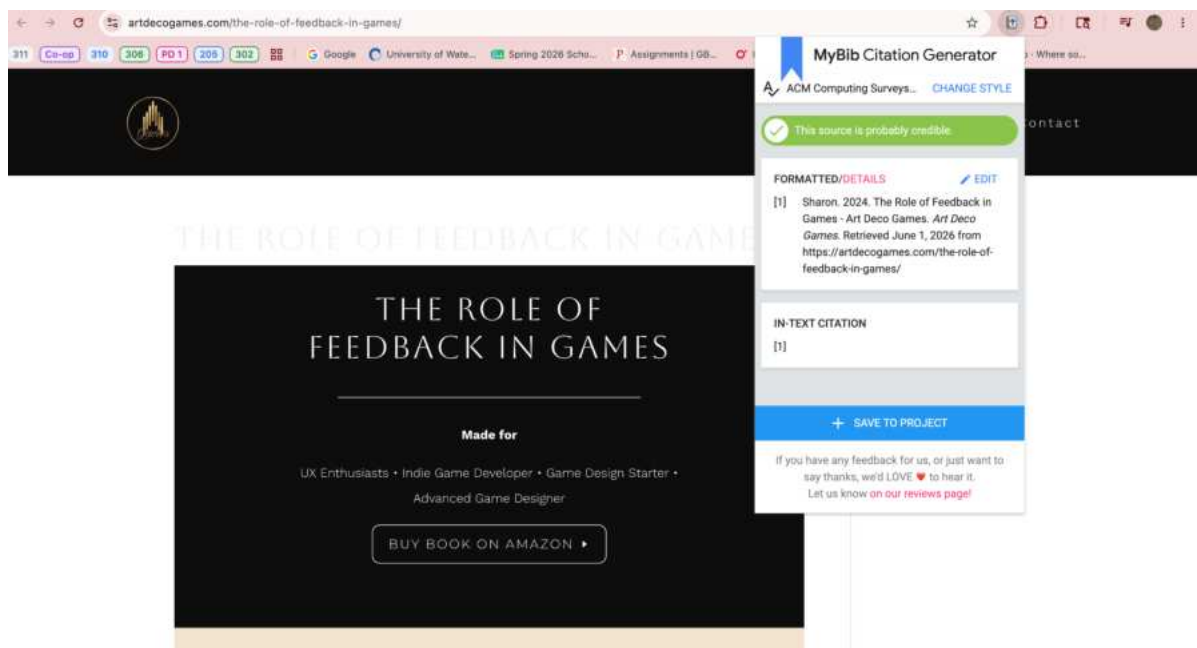
Watching a video tutorial of Luigi's Mansion 3 to analyze affordances



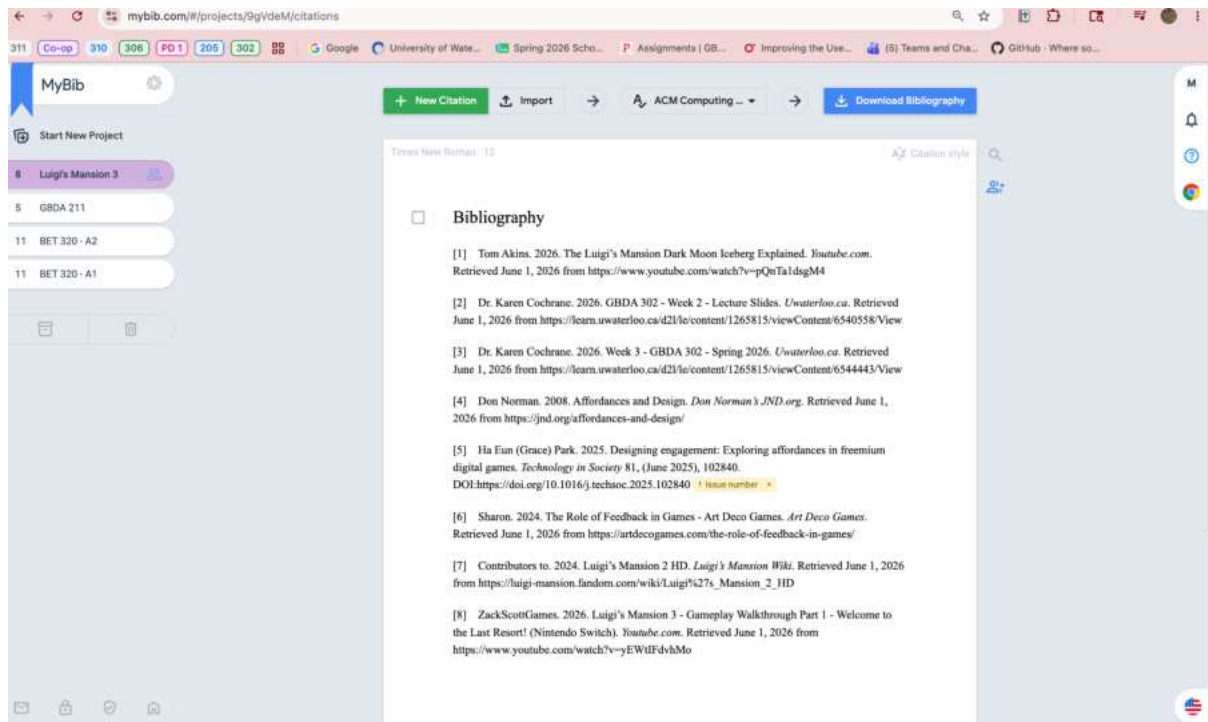
Reading through a peer-reviewed journal about designing engaging games with affordances



Creating a ACM citation for our groups reference list, ensuring the source is credible and cited in ACM format

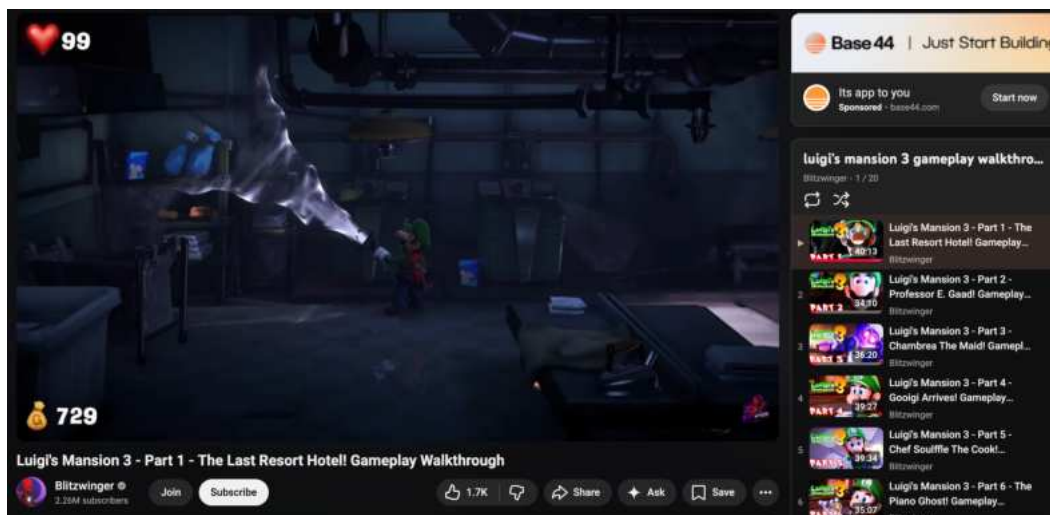


Reviewing our teams reference list with our first 8 websites researched to ensure the websites are credible and to keep track of our groups references



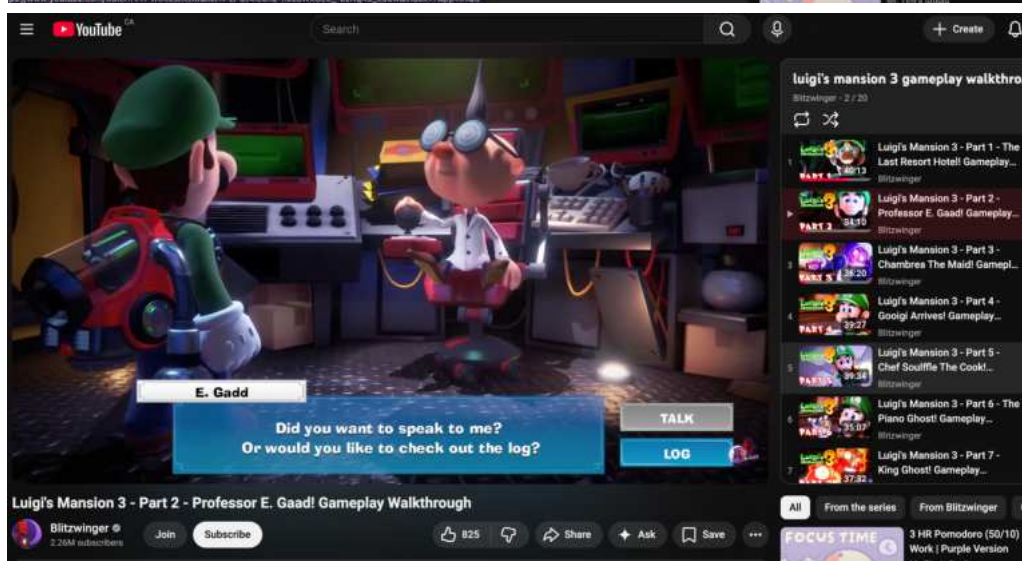
Amy Liu

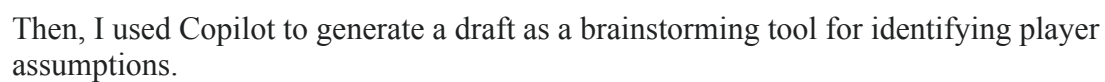
To understand the game's mechanics and overall experience, I first watched tutorial videos to learn how the game works.

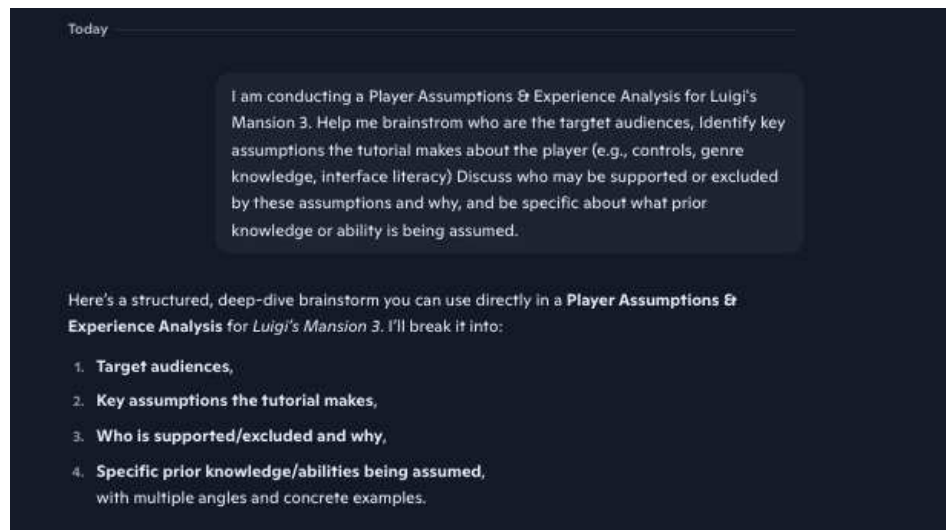


I followed the list and continued watching different parts of the gameplay.

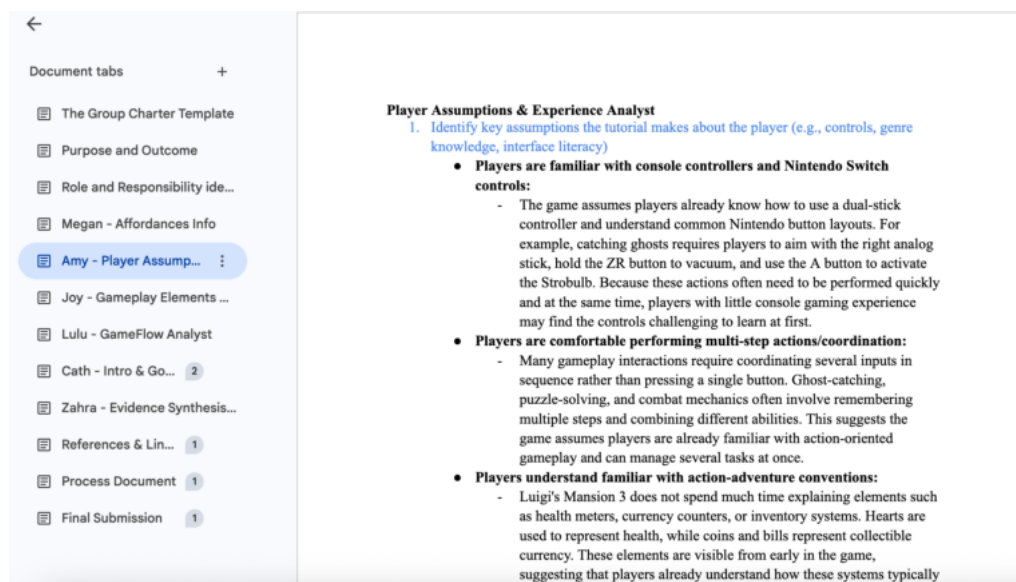
Through watching YouTube videos, I gained a basic understanding of the game, which allowed me to explore more deeply what the game assumes about its players and who its target audience is.



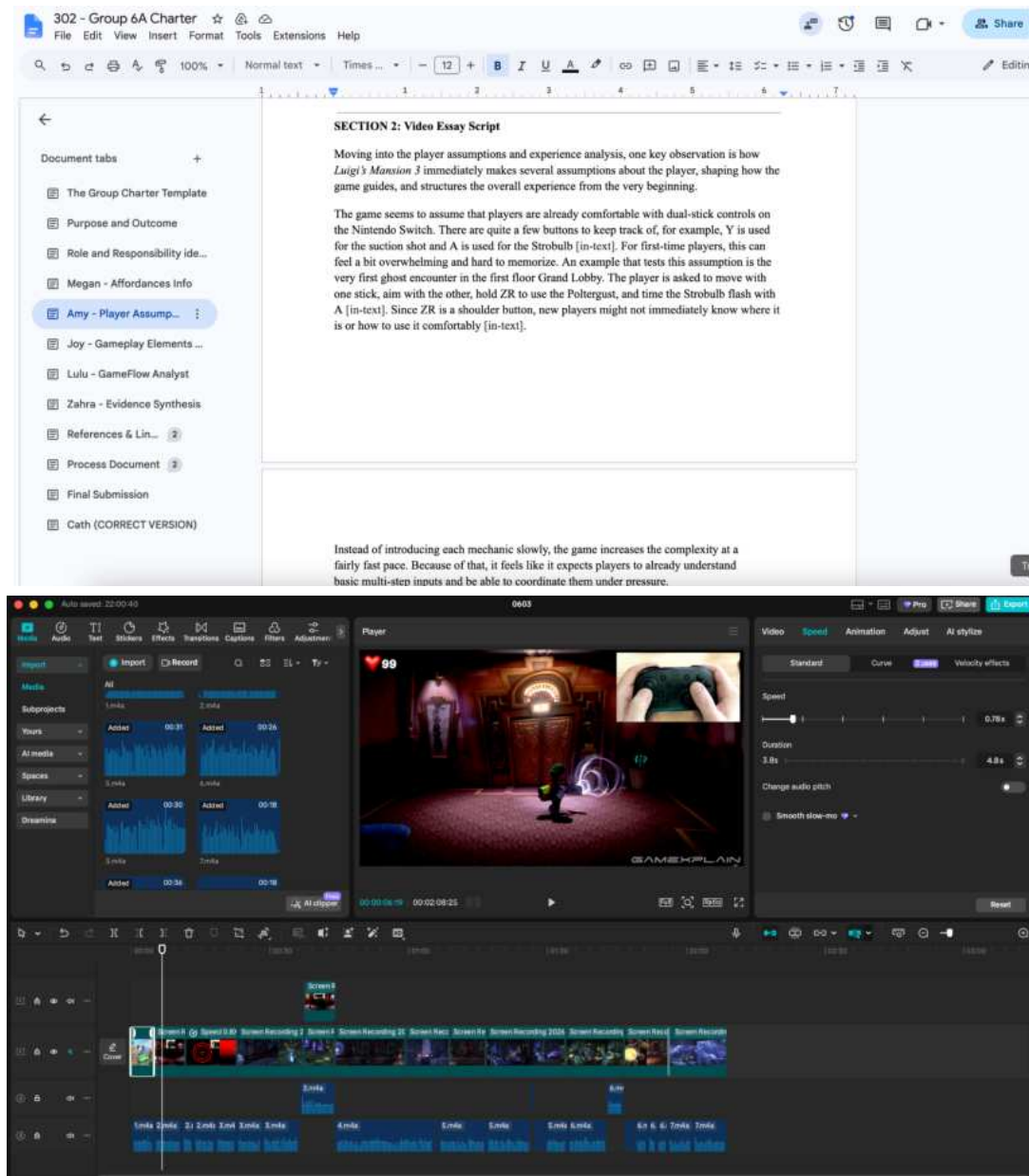




Next, I combined the insights from Copilot with my own observations and organized them into a Google Doc.

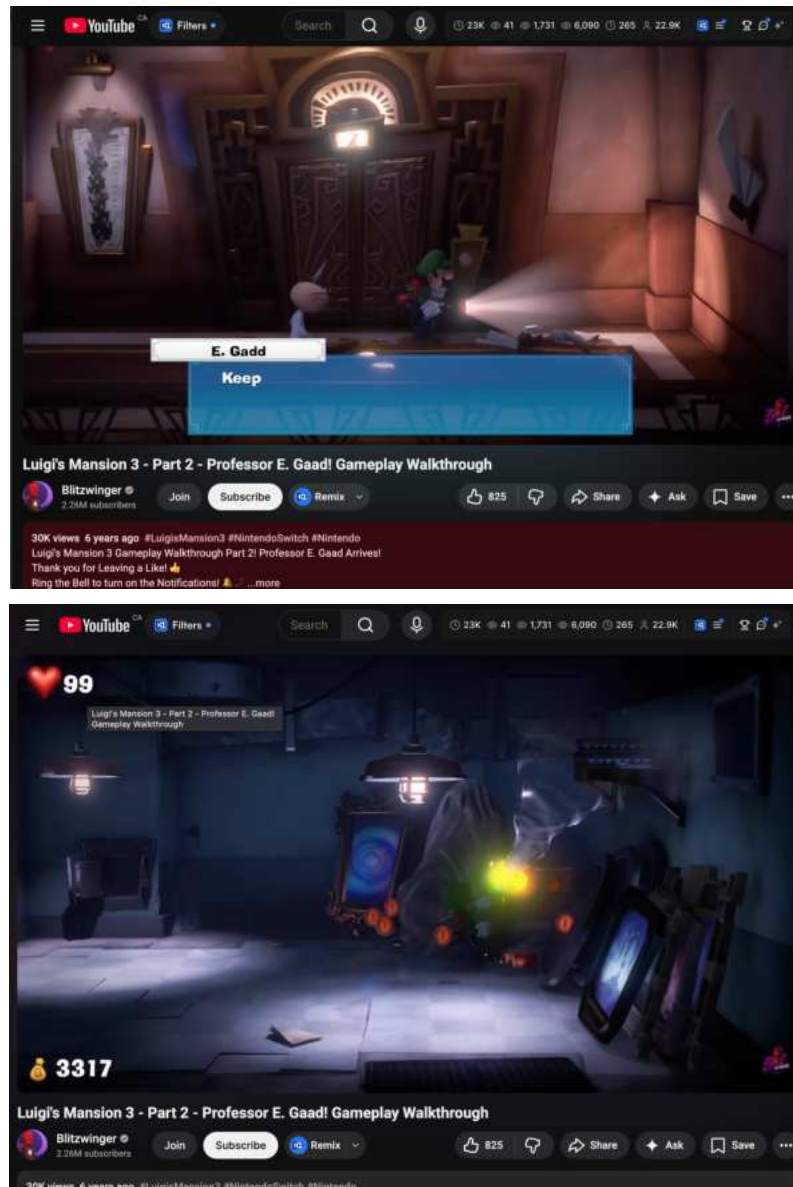


Lastly, I finalized my script on the google doc and used CapCut to combine the footage and narration into a cohesive video segment.

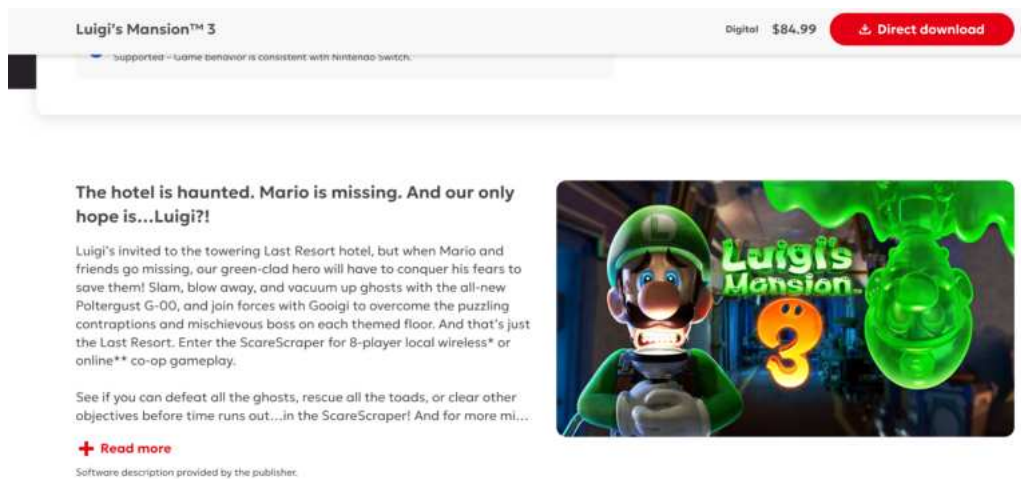


Joy Zhang

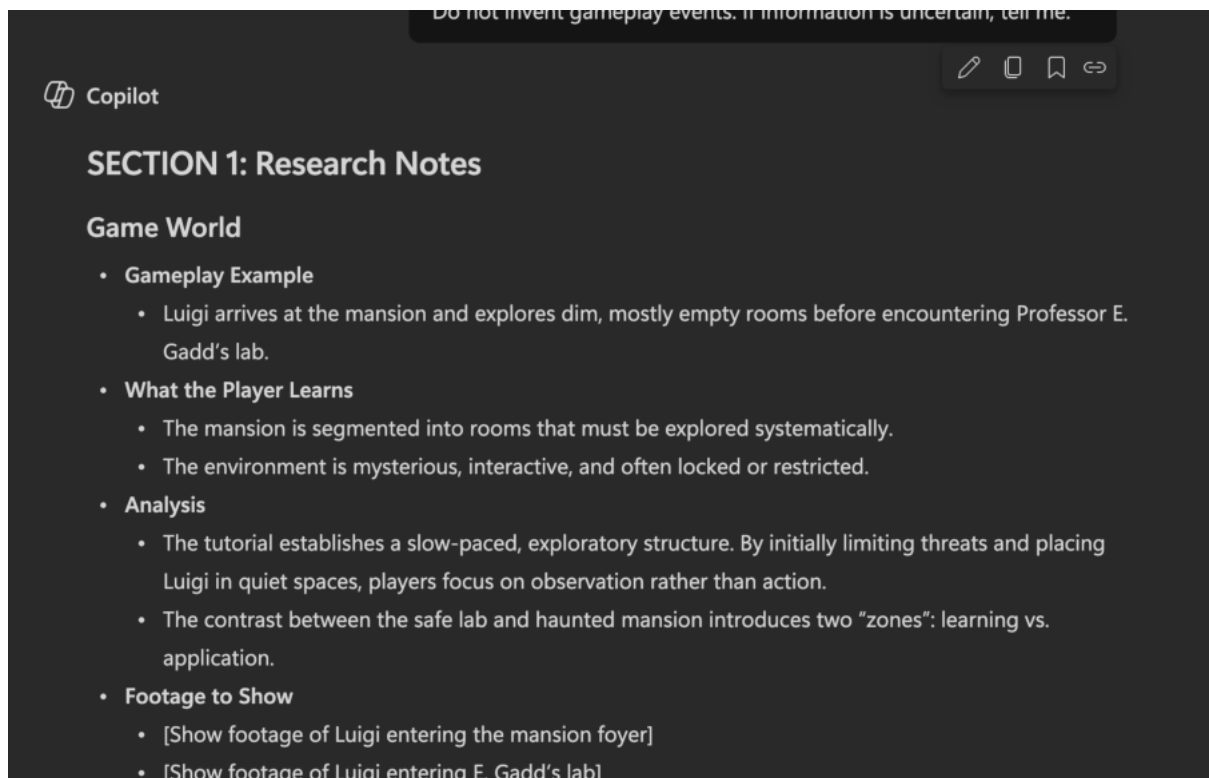
I watched a gameplay walkthrough on YouTube to learn about the game.



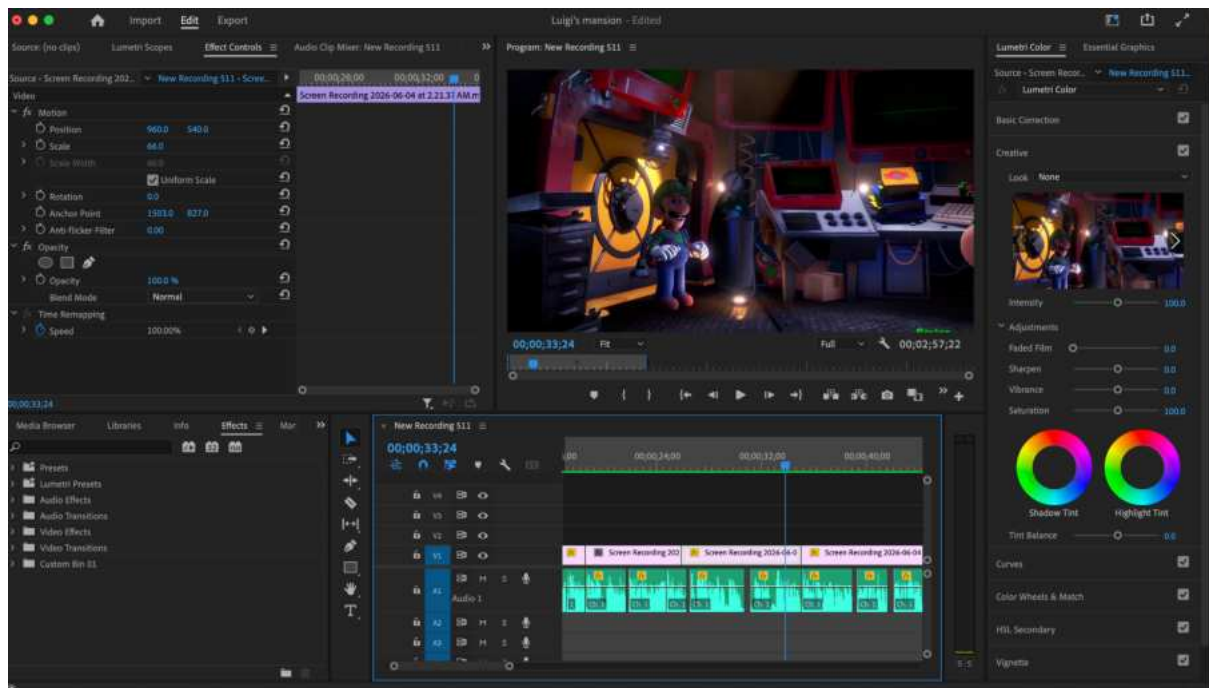
I also reviewed Nintendo's official website to better understand the game's mechanics, setting, and objectives.



I used Microsoft Copilot to generate initial analysis and identify gameplay examples, then reviewed and refined the information using gameplay footage and official sources.



Then, I edited the voiceover and gameplay footage together on Premiere Pro.



Lulu Dabyan

Watching the Luigi's Mansion 3 HD tutorial walkthrough on YouTube to identify specific gameplay moments relevant to each GameFlow principle. This was essential for grounding the analysis in concrete examples from the tutorial rather than general descriptions.

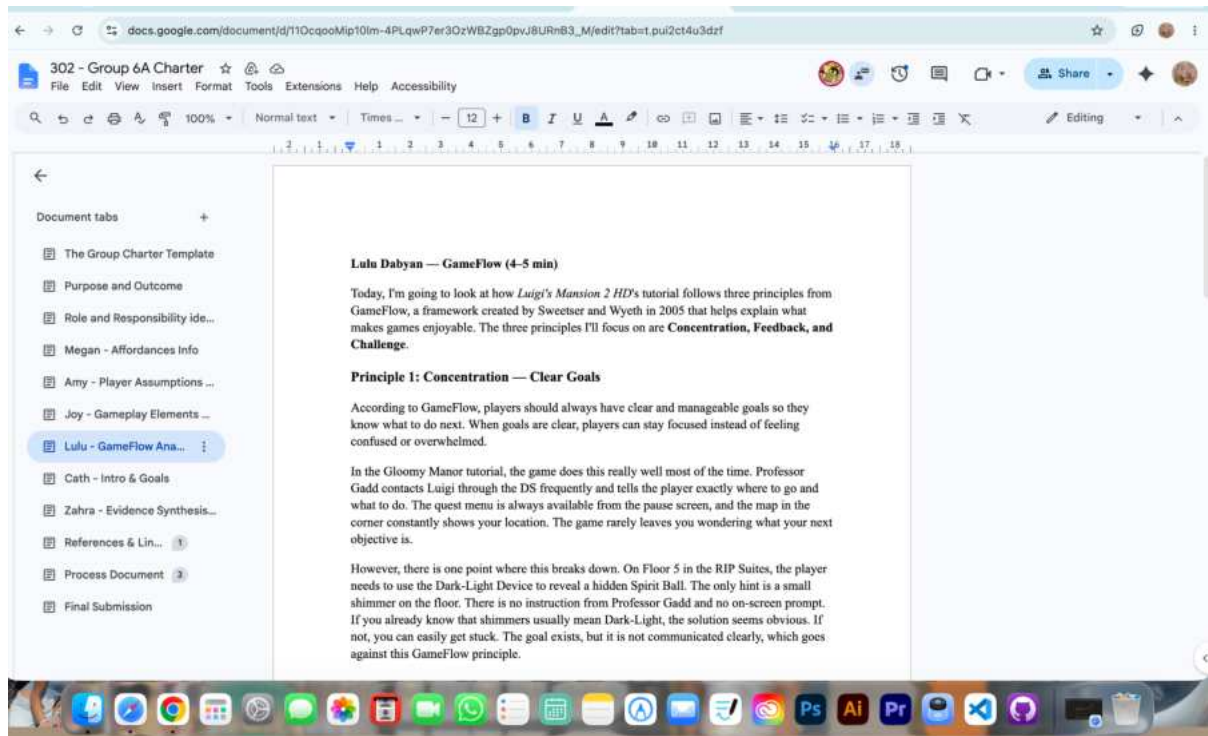
Luigi's Mansion 2 HD Full Game Walkthrough!

YouTube : Zebra Gamer : Aug 1, 2024

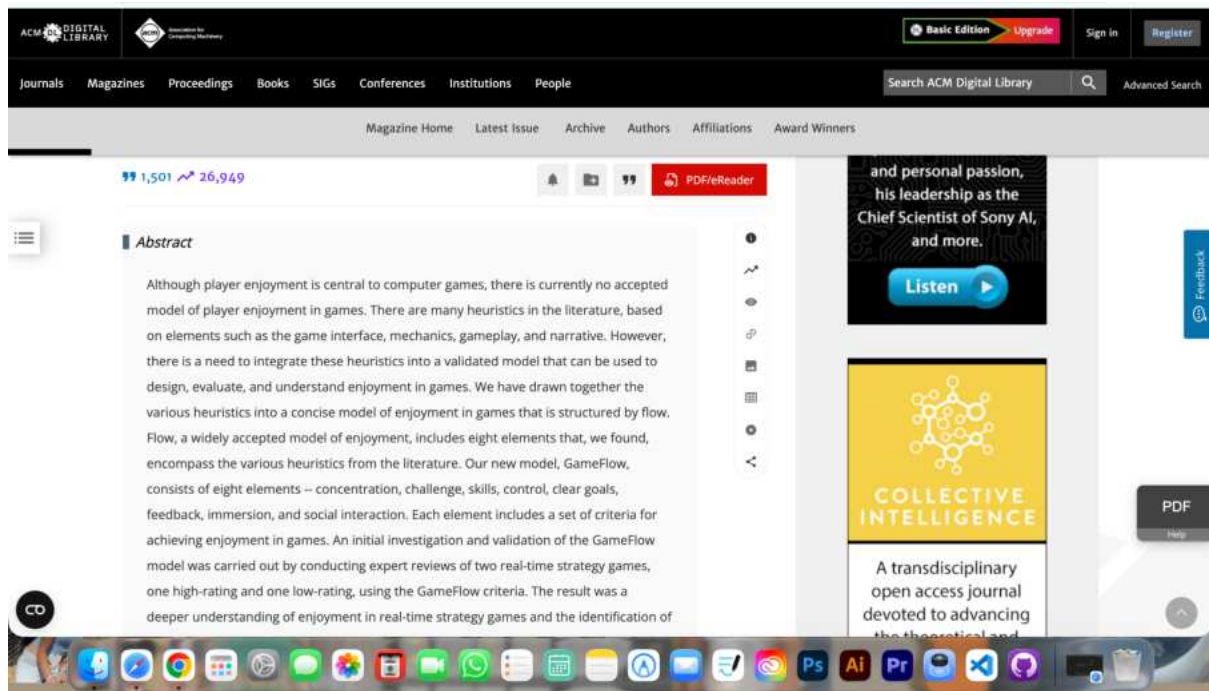
YouTube



Writing the GameFlow section of the group script in our shared Google Doc, drafting analysis for the Concentration, Feedback, and Challenge principles. This shows the script in progress before final edits were made.

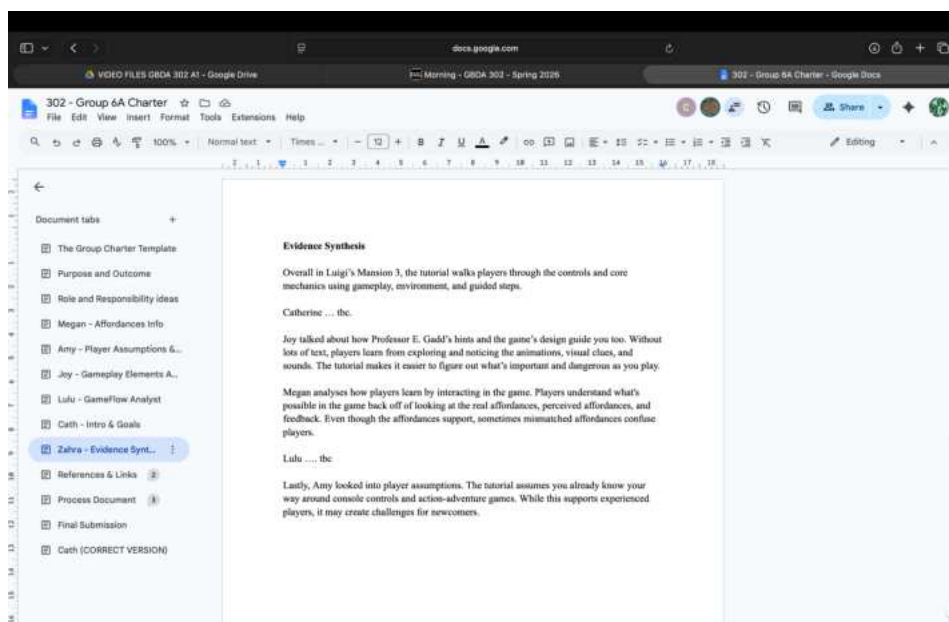


Reading the article GameFlow paper to ensure the three selected principles were accurately defined and applied to the tutorial analysis. Including a peer-reviewed source was a requirement for this section of the essay.

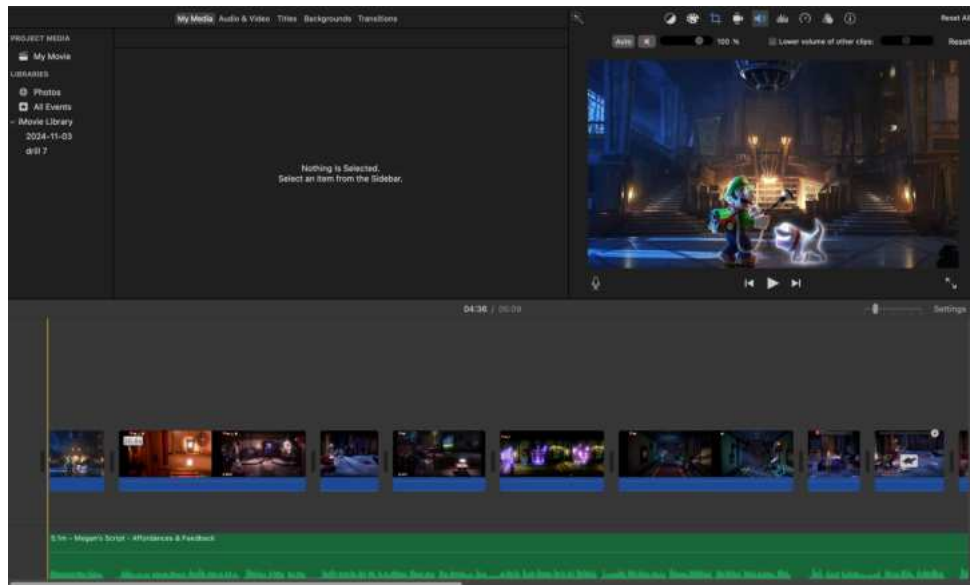


Zahra Omar

Screenshot of in the process of writing my evidence synthesis script. I went section by section for each person's analysis.

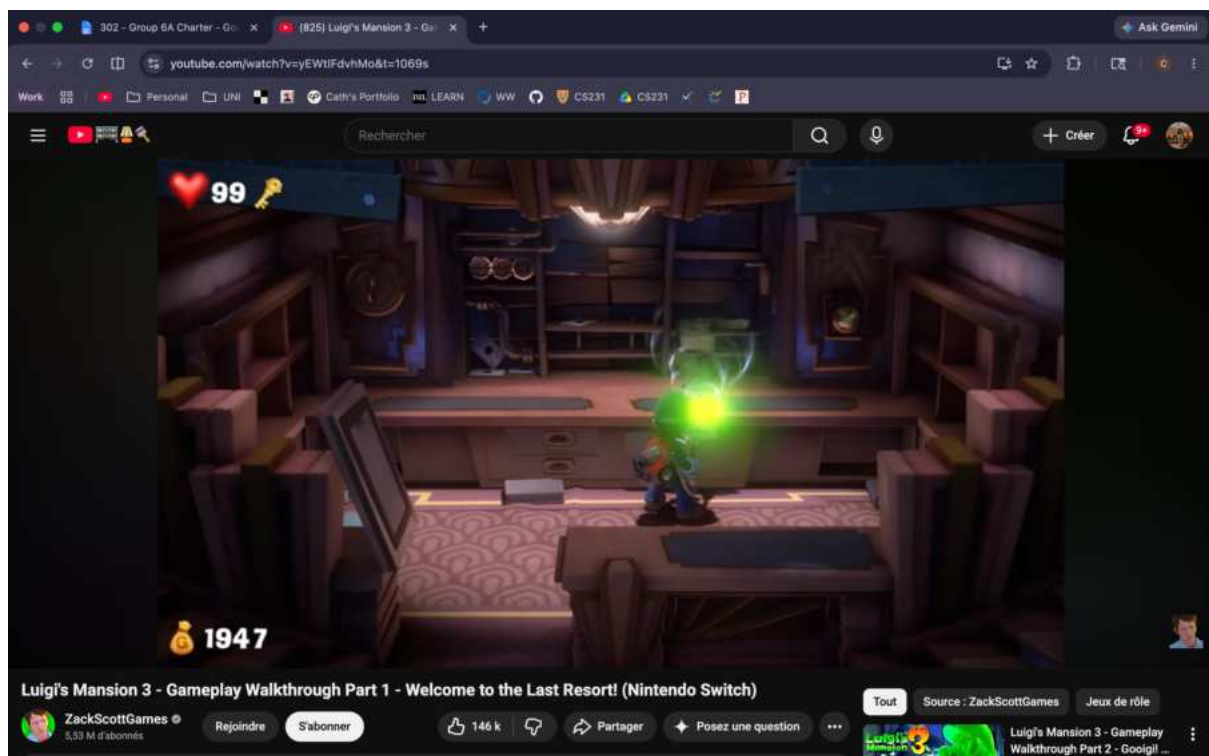


Screenshot of using iMovie to combine real gameplay footage and the script voice over.



Catherine Patterson

Watching a Youtube Walkthrough by a first-time player of Luigi's Mansion 3 which was useful in identifying how player controls and game mechanics are introduced. Because this was a first-time player, they also made mistakes which I could also draw insights from (like taking damage from rats or spiders).



Taking notes about Luigi's Mansion 2's storyline and how player controls are introduced. Though this was done by mistake at first, this information proved useful in drawing parallels between the two games.

Tutorial role:

- Poltergust 5000 (A1 quest), sending Luigi to retrieve the ghost hunting gear
- Introduce basic moving controls, how to move through levels (opening doors... map, quests)
- Getting the strobulb to build the poltergust and see it in use
- How to defeat ghosts in safe environment (ghosts don't do much damage)
- What might do damage and visual feedback (player flashing red when loosing health) (via ghost attacks -20 2:22:42, interacting with objects like the knights -20, ghost throwing items -10 57:06, bat attacks 1:54:23)
- What kind of objects the player can interact with
- Done through communication with Professor Gadd on DS (smart storytelling)

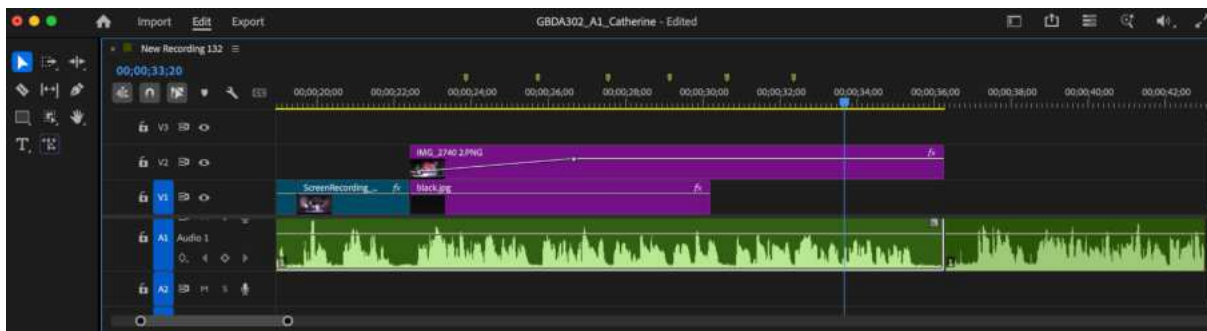
Win/Lose condition:

- Win if you complete all the quests for a mission with remaining health
- Lose if player loses 100 health

Player controls:

- Move front back and sides using arrows / left stick
- Tilt controller to look up, down and aim (good for finding treasure)
- A to answer DS and next message
- Hold B while walking to run

Adding timeline markers in Premiere Pro to make the section headers text appear one at a time while I am explaining each role in the introduction, providing a clear linear video structure overview.



GenAI Declaration

GenAI was used in this project. We used Microsoft Copilot (University of Waterloo account), GPT-5–class conversational model (or most current version available).

GenAI Documentation (Only if GenAI was Used)

[Megan Pilkey GenAI Documentation](https://copilot.microsoft.com/shares/CkY51HNJParW43kiz1L6o)

<https://copilot.microsoft.com/shares/CkY51HNJParW43kiz1L6o>

[Amy Liu GenAI Documentation](https://copilot.microsoft.com/shares/sfbF6vDC3o4W6Ds3ehZVG)

<https://copilot.microsoft.com/shares/sfbF6vDC3o4W6Ds3ehZVG>

[Joy Zhang GenAI Documentation](https://m365.cloud.microsoft/chat/conversation/4fd1472e-831d-4134-86a5-34cf858e08db)

<https://m365.cloud.microsoft/chat/conversation/4fd1472e-831d-4134-86a5-34cf858e08db>

[Zahra Omar GenAI Documentation](https://copilot.microsoft.com/shares/8XXh8oVCzFXktGXErXH8E)

<https://copilot.microsoft.com/shares/8XXh8oVCzFXktGXErXH8E>

[Lulu Dabyan GenAI Documentation](https://copilot.microsoft.com/shares/sfbF6vDC3o4W6Ds3ehZVG)

<https://copilot.microsoft.com/shares/sfbF6vDC3o4W6Ds3ehZVG>

Catherine Patterson did not use GenAI to complete this assignment.

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Appendix - Group Charter

1. Group Members

List all group members and preferred methods of contact.

Shadow roles are intended to support interdependence and flexibility if group responsibilities shift.

Name	Preferred Contact Method	Primary Role	Shadow Role
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Megan Pilkey	mhpilkey@uwaterloo.ca	Affordances Analyst	Reference formatting
Catherine Patterson	cmlppatt@uwaterloo.ca	Introduction & Game Structure Analyst	Editing support
Amy Liu	a383liu@uwaterloo.ca	Player Assumptions & Experience Analyst	Affordances support Editing support
Lulu Dabyan	ldabyan@uwaterloo.ca	GameFlow Analyst	Script integration support
Joy Zhang	j2638zha@uwaterloo.ca	Gameplay Elements Analyst	Editing support
Zahra Omar	z6omar@uwaterloo.ca	Evidence Synthesis & Presentation Analyst	Final editing / documentation support

2. Roles and Responsibilities

Name	Primary Role	Primary Role Description
Amy Liu	Player Assumptions & Experience Analyst	- Identify key assumptions the tutorial makes about the player (e.g., controls, genre knowledge, interface literacy) - Discuss who may be supported or excluded by these assumptions and why - Be specific about what prior knowledge or ability is being assumed - Ground your discussion in specific gameplay examples - Briefly reflect on how your own perspective influenced your interpretation
Catherine Patterson	- Introduction - Game Structure & Core Elements	- Introduce the game and focus of the analysis (tutorial level only) - Explain the role of tutorials in shaping player learning and experience - Identify genre and briefly situate the game - Outline the structure of the video - Game Goal - Win/lose condition - Player control - Game mechanics - Game loop

Joy Zhang	Gameplay Elements Analyst	- Analyze how the tutorial introduces gameplay elements such as the game world, player character, rules/constraints, interface, and audio/visual feedback - Collect tutorial-specific gameplay examples to support analysis and claims - Identify how these elements teach core mechanics and help guide player understanding - Assist with organizing gameplay footage and examples for the video essay
Lulu Dabyan		- Analyze how the tutorial level flows and progresses - Look at how the game teaches mechanics step by step - Identify how the game guides the player using level design and visual cues - Explain how players learn without many written instructions - Connect gameplay flow to the player's learning experience - Help combine different script sections into one smooth video essay - Support the group by keeping the analysis clear and organized
Megan Pilkey	Affordances Analyst	- Define real affordances, perceived affordances, and feedback in your own words - Provide at least three tutorial-specific examples using gameplay footage - Include at least one example of aligned (perceptible) and misaligned (e.g., false or hidden) affordances - Explain how these relationships support or hinder player learning - Include at least one peer-reviewed citation beyond course materials
Zahra Omar	Evidence Synthesis & Presentation Analyst	- Organize gameplay examples from all analytical sections, ensure each claim is supported by specific tutorial evidence, and connect findings into a cohesive argument. - Assist with structuring presentation flow, maintaining consistency across sections, and supporting final documentation and review. - Organizing GitHub

Name	Shadow Role + Responsibilities
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Amu Liu	Affordance Support Supporting Megan with affordances
Catherine Patterson	Editing support - Assist with sequencing of gameplay footage to have relevant visuals when the speaker is talking - Match narration to video clips with proper timing, transitions and text
Zahra Omar	Final editing Edit the videos for the essay, clipping and joining together.
Megan Pilkey	Reference Formating - Ensure all references are in ACM format - Assist with citing all sources, including videos and gameplay footage
Lulu Dabyan	- Help connect different parts of the script together - Make sure ideas flow smoothly between sections - Help organize the overall structure of the video essay - Review group work for clarity and consistency - Support team members when combining analysis into the final script
Joy Zhang	- Assist with organizing gameplay footage and selecting relevant clips for the video essay - Support video editing through clip timing, pacing, transitions, and syncing visuals with narration - Provide feedback on edited sections when needed

Everyone

(Megan Pilkey, Catherine Patterson, Amy Liu, Lulu Dabyan, Joy Zhang & Zahra Omar)

Use GenAI, each team member individually logs each of these GenAI-related responsibilities such as:

- prompt drafting
- verification
- synthesis
- documentation

3. Communication and Access Practices

Explain how your group will communicate, collaborate, and support accessibility throughout the project.

- Microsoft Teams - Team calls, aim to meet twice a week, give updates in class
- [Lettuce meet - Scheduling](#)
- Due dates within the assignment - google docs and Instagram group chat
- Shared Google Drive for assignment parts (facilitate editing)

4. Pedagogy of Care and Understanding

This section should describe how your group will approach collaboration with empathy, flexibility, accountability, and mutual respect.

- Team members must attend each meeting or at least inform the group in advance if they are unable to attend.
- Team members should respect each other's opinions, reply on the same day
- All team members must finish assigned tasks by our group deadline, or let the team know 24hours in advance if they will not be able to complete on time
- Team members should ask each other if there is something that is not understood to avoid misunderstanding in their work and potentially leading to errors.
- Team members carefully review the assignment details and understand what is being asked of in their role (reach out to team members for further clarification)
- Team members treat each other with kindness, mutual understanding and hear everyone's ideas equally